

Acceptable Use Policy

Document Control

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Approved By	Executive Management
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1. Purpose

This policy establishes the rules for acceptable use of TechSecure Solutions Inc.'s information systems, networks, devices, and data. Its purpose is to protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of company and client information, safeguard confidential project and intellectual property, ensure the security of the corporate network and cloud development environment, and set clear expectations for how employees may use company resources — including personal use of email and the internet, software installation, social media, personal devices, and data handling.

This policy is issued in response to recent incidents involving personal use of work email, unauthorized software installations, disclosure of confidential project information on social media, and unapproved personal devices connecting to the corporate network.

2. Scope

2.1 Applicability

This policy applies to:

- ☑ All employees
- ☑ Contractors and consultants
- ☑ Third-party vendors with access to company systems
- ☑ Remote workers

2.2 Systems/Assets Covered

This policy covers all TechSecure Solutions Inc. information systems and resources, including: the cloud-based development environment, corporate email accounts, the corporate network and VPN, collaboration tools (e.g., chat, video conferencing, file sharing), company-issued laptops and mobile devices, and any personal device approved for business use under the BYOD provisions of this policy. It applies across all three office locations and to all remote work arrangements.

2.3 Exclusions

This policy does not apply to personal devices or personal accounts that have not been registered for business use and that do not connect to company systems or networks.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Internet Usage

Internet access is provided primarily to support business activities. Limited personal use is permitted where it does not interfere with work performance, system security, or company resources.

Requirements:

- Internet access must not be used to visit sites containing illegal, offensive, discriminatory, or harmful content
- Limited personal browsing is permitted during breaks and must not consume excessive bandwidth or storage
- Employees must not use company internet access to download pirated software, media, or other copyrighted material without authorization
- Internet traffic on company networks and devices is subject to monitoring and logging for security purposes; employees should have no expectation of privacy when using company systems
- Use of anonymizing tools (e.g., unauthorized VPNs, proxy servers, Tor) to bypass network security controls is prohibited unless approved by IT Security

3.2 Email Usage

Company email accounts are provided for business communication and must be used responsibly.

Requirements:

- Company email must be used primarily for business purposes; incidental personal use is permitted but must be minimal and must not involve commercial, political, or offensive content
- Confidential company or client information must not be sent to personal email accounts or unauthorized external recipients
- Employees must not open attachments or click links from unknown or suspicious senders, and must report suspected phishing to IT Security immediately
- Email must not be used to send harassing, discriminatory, defamatory, or offensive content
- Business email records are retained for a minimum of 3 years, or longer where required by legal, regulatory, or contractual obligations, and are subject to review during audits, investigations, or litigation holds
- Auto-forwarding of company email to personal or external accounts is prohibited

3.3 Software

Only approved software may be installed or used on company systems to reduce security risk and maintain license compliance.

Requirements:

- Employees may only install software from the company's approved software catalog
- Requests for new software must be submitted to IT Security for review and approval prior to installation, including a review of licensing, security, and business need
- Employees are prohibited from installing unauthorized applications, browser extensions, or development tools on company-managed systems, including the cloud development environment
- Open-source components used in company development projects must go through the standard dependency approval and vulnerability scanning process
- IT Security will periodically audit installed software across company systems and may remove unauthorized software without prior notice

3.4 Social Media

Employees must exercise discretion and professionalism when using social media, whether posting personally or on behalf of the company.

Requirements:

- Employees must never disclose confidential, proprietary, or client information on social media, including details about unreleased products, projects, code, clients, or internal business matters
- Employees posting about the company in a personal capacity must not present personal opinions as official company positions and are encouraged to include a disclaimer where relevant
- Only individuals formally authorized by the Marketing or Communications team may post on official company social media accounts or speak on behalf of the company publicly
- Employees must not use social media to disparage the company, coworkers, clients, or partners
- Suspected leaks of confidential information via social media must be reported to IT Security and Human Resources immediately

3.5 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Personal devices may be used to access company systems only after registration and in compliance with security requirements.

Requirements:

- Personal devices (laptops, tablets, smartphones) must be registered with IT Security and enrolled in the company's mobile device management (MDM) solution before connecting to the corporate network, VPN, or company email/cloud environment
- Registered devices must meet minimum security requirements, including up-to-date operating system patches, an active screen lock/passcode, and full-disk or device encryption
- Company data on a registered personal device must be kept within approved, containerized business applications where available, separate from personal data
- Lost or stolen devices that have accessed company systems must be reported to IT Security within 24 hours so the device can be remotely locked or wiped
- Unregistered personal devices are prohibited from connecting to the corporate network, VPN, or cloud development environment
- Upon termination of employment or contract, employees must allow IT Security to remove company data and access from any registered personal device

3.6 Data Handling

Company and client data must be stored, shared, and disposed of securely at all times.

Requirements:

- Company and client data must be stored only in approved, company-managed systems (e.g., approved cloud storage, the corporate development environment), not on unauthorized personal cloud accounts or removable media
- Data must be classified and handled according to its sensitivity (e.g., Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted), with Confidential and Restricted data requiring encryption in transit and at rest
- Sharing of company or client data with external parties requires appropriate authorization and, where applicable, a signed confidentiality or data-sharing agreement
- Data must be disposed of securely when no longer needed, including secure deletion of digital files and proper destruction of any physical media, in accordance with the company's data retention schedule
- Employees must not copy confidential source code, client data, or project materials to personal storage, personal accounts, or unapproved third-party services

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Executive Management	Approve this policy, allocate resources for its implementation, and demonstrate visible commitment to acceptable use standards
IT Security Team	Maintain the approved software catalog, manage the BYOD/MDM program, monitor network and email use, investigate reported violations, and enforce technical controls
Marketing/Communications Team	Manage official company social media accounts and authorize designated spokespeople
Department Managers	Ensure their teams understand and comply with this policy and address minor issues within their teams

All Employees, Contractors, and Vendors	Comply with this policy, use company systems responsibly, register personal devices before business use, and report suspected violations or security incidents
Human Resources	Support investigations into policy violations and administer disciplinary action in coordination with management

5. Compliance

5.1 Monitoring

IT Security will monitor use of company networks, email, internet access, and cloud systems using automated tools, including logging, content filtering, and data loss prevention (DLP) systems, to detect policy violations and security risks. Monitoring is conducted in accordance with applicable law and is limited to company-owned systems and company data on registered personal devices.

5.2 Reporting

Suspected policy violations, data leaks, or security incidents must be reported to IT Security at andrei@cyberdlh.lu or via the IT Service Desk. Reports may be made anonymously through the confidential ethics hotline where preferred.

5.3 Auditing

Compliance with this policy will be audited at least twice annually by the IT Security Team, including reviews of installed software, registered BYOD devices, and data handling practices, with findings reported to Executive Management.

6. Enforcement

6.1 Violations

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Suspension of system access privileges, including network, email, or BYOD access
- Mandatory retraining on acceptable use
- Disciplinary action up to and including termination

- Legal action where applicable, including in cases involving disclosure of confidential information or client data

6.2 Reporting Violations

Report suspected violations to IT Security at andrei@cyberdlh.lu, via the IT Service Desk, or through the confidential ethics hotline.

7. Exceptions

7.1 Exception Process

Exceptions to this policy require:

1. A written request submitted to the CISO
2. A documented business justification
3. A risk assessment conducted by the IT Security Team
4. Compensating controls where applicable (e.g., additional monitoring or restricted access)
5. Formal written approval and documentation retained by the IT Security Team

7.2 Exception Duration

All exceptions must have a defined end date and be reviewed quarterly until resolved or formally extended.

8. Definitions

Term	Definition
Acceptable Use	The set of behaviors and practices approved for interacting with company systems, networks, and data
BYOD (Bring Your Own Device)	The practice of using a personally owned device to access company systems after registration and approval
MDM (Mobile Device Management)	Software used to manage, secure, and monitor devices that access company data and systems
Confidential Information	Non-public information, including project details, source code, client data, and business plans, whose disclosure could harm the company or its clients

Data Loss Prevention (DLP)	Tools and processes used to detect and prevent unauthorized transmission of sensitive data outside the company
Approved Software Catalog	The list of applications and tools that have been reviewed and approved by IT Security for use on company systems

9. Related Documents

- Password Policy
- Information Security Policy
- Data Classification and Handling Standard
- Social Media Policy
- Mobile Device Management (MDM) Standard
- Incident Response Plan

10. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	2026-08-19	CISO	Initial release, addressing personal email use, unauthorized software, social media disclosures, and unapproved BYOD connections

11. Acknowledgment

By accessing TechSecure Solutions Inc. systems, all employees, contractors, and vendors acknowledge they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Acceptable Use Policy.

For formal acknowledgment tracking, use the company's policy acknowledgment system.

End of Policy Document